

The Founder Delegation Audit

Find the 15 hours a week you're doing a \$10/hour job

A 20-minute worksheet that ranks what to hand off first, counts what it costs you to keep it, and scripts the handoff conversation you've been avoiding.

20 MINUTES

3 STEPS

ONE UNCOMFORTABLE NUMBER

You became a founder to do founder work. Somewhere along the way, your week filled up with inbox triage, scheduling, CRM updates and follow-ups — \$10/hour work inside a \$100/hour brain. This audit makes the trade visible: what each task is really costing you, and what to hand off first. Do it honestly. The math is uncomfortable on purpose.

1 • LOG

List every recurring task you did this week. Recurring only — one-off fires don't count.

2 • SCORE

Rate each task on two questions: what it costs to hire out, and whether it truly needs you.

3 • RANK & HAND OFF

Sort by score, total the hours, and run the handoff script on your top task.

STEP 1

The Task Log

List every task you did more than once this week. Not sure what counts? The usual suspects: email triage · calendar management · CRM updates · invoicing · following up with leads or customers · social posting · data entry · research · meeting notes · order processing · recruiting admin · travel booking · report building.

#	TASK	HOURS/WK	TIMES/WK
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			

10	
11	
12	

STEP 2

Score every task (two questions each)

Q1 — Hire-out cost		POINTS
What would it cost to hire someone to do this?		
A	Under \$15/hour — data entry, scheduling, inbox triage	3
B	\$15–50/hour — follow-ups, CRM updates, reporting	2
C	\$50+/hour — strategy, sales, product	0

Q2 — You vs. anyone		POINTS
Does this task need you, or just need doing?		
A	Anyone trained could do it	3
B	Needs judgment, but not my judgment	2
C	Genuinely needs me — vision, key relationships	0

Delegation Score = Q1 + Q2. Maximum 6 points per task. Write each score in the margin next to your task log.

If you scored C on Q2 but A on Q1, that's a systemize-first task — write the process down once, then hand it off.

STEP 3

Rank and recover

Sort your tasks by Delegation Score, highest first. Everything scoring 4–6 goes on your Delegation Shortlist. Add up the hours — that's your recoverable week.

TASK	SCORE	HOURS/WEEK	WHO COULD OWN IT
			Right Hand
			Right Hand
			Right Hand
			Later / systemize
			Keep (founder work)

Your recoverable hours per week:

What those hours are worth

Recoverable hours × 50 weeks × your effective hourly rate (last year's profit ÷ hours worked). Founders who run this audit typically find 10–15 hours a week — over 600 hours a year of founder-level work stuck in assistant-level tasks.

YOUR FIRST HANDOFF CONVERSATION

The script nobody gives you

Most delegation fails at the handoff, not the hiring. When you're ready — with a Right Hand or with your current team — use this:

"I've audited my week and this task — [TASK] — is now yours. Here's what 'done' looks like: [OUTCOME, NOT METHOD]. You own it end to end. The decision I'm delegating to you: [E.G. REFUNDS UNDER \$100]. Check in with me Friday with one question: what did you decide?"

The three rules that make it stick

- Hand off the outcome, not the method. If you script their steps, you've built a \$10/hour puppet — and you're still the operator.
- Delegate one decision authority with every task. That's what makes it permanent.
- Check in weekly on decisions made, never on tasks done.

The bottleneck isn't your team. It's the handoff.

If your audit found 10+ recoverable hours, the constraint is no longer what to delegate — it's finding a person you trust to take it. That's the part Pareto Talent does: hand-picked, AI-trained Right Hand candidates matched to your audit within 24 hours, backed by the Freedom 40 guarantee (reclaim 40 hours in your first 30 days or the next month is free) and lifetime replacement.

Book your Matching Call at paretotalent.com — bring this audit. Your shortlist is your first job description.